

Waze Cargo

Go-To-Market Strategy

GTM Assignment — BTS MSc AI & Data Solutions — May 2026

The ocean doesn't wait. Now you can move before it does.

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1. Product & Problem

Product name: Waze Cargo

One-line description: Predictive port congestion intelligence that helps Chilean importers and exporters choose the right port, at the right time, before delays happen.

Customer problem we solve:

Companies involved in international trade in Chile face significant risks from maritime shipment delays, yet they have no tools to predict port congestion before it happens. This affects both sides of the trade. On the import side, 98.6% of Chilean firms are small and medium enterprises importing machinery, electronics, vehicles, and pharmaceuticals. A five-day port delay means empty shelves, missed production deadlines, and contractual penalties. On the export side, Chile is the world's number one copper producer and a top exporter of fresh fruit, salmon, wine, lithium, and forestry products. A congested port during grape harvest in March or cherry season in December means spoiled perishables and lost international contracts worth millions.

Cargo insurance covers physical damage but does not cover these indirect commercial and operational losses. At the same time, no existing tool translates delay predictions into importer or exporter-oriented risk management. Companies operate in reactive mode, dealing with disruptions after they occur instead of anticipating them. Additionally, ports can close due to abnormal ocean swells and high winds with little warning, and no current platform combines trade data with oceanographic forecasts to address this.

Why now?

The global port congestion analytics market reached 1.8 billion dollars in 2025, growing at 13.5% annually to 5.6 billion by 2034, according to DataIntel. AI maturity has reached the point where gradient boosting models like LightGBM outperform classical time series on tabular datasets under 50,000 rows, which matches our data profile exactly, as demonstrated by Grinsztajn et al. at NeurIPS 2022. Chilean customs data covering 24 years of trade records is publicly available, and Open-Meteo provides free marine weather APIs, making the data infrastructure cost near zero. Finally, COVID-19 exposed the fragility of reactive logistics, and companies are actively seeking predictive tools. According to IAPH 2025, only 31% of ports have adopted analytics platforms, leaving 69% of the market untapped.

2. Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Primary segment: Small and medium Chilean importers and exporters. These are companies in international trade handling between 500,000 and 50 million dollars in annual trade volume, with two to fifty employees, concentrated in the Santiago metropolitan area (which accounts for 70% of import activity), the Valparaíso Region (fruit exports), and the Antofagasta Region (mining exports).

Key roles and decision makers:

The logistics manager or supply chain coordinator who makes daily routing decisions. The import or export operations manager who selects ports and books carriers. In micro and small firms, the general manager or owner who makes all decisions and is highly cost-sensitive.

Main pains and jobs to be done:

Importers need to know whether the port where their cargo will arrive in Chile will be congested three weeks from now. Exporters need to decide today whether to ship their grapes through Valparaíso or San Antonio in March, and which one will have cold storage availability. Both sides want to be alerted if weather conditions will close their target port so they can reroute before the vessel departs.

Existing alternatives and competitors:

Competitor	What they offer	What they miss	Price
MarineTraffic	Live vessel map, GPS-based ETA, historical routes	No congestion prediction, no commodity data, no weather risk	EUR 100-150/mo
VesselFinder	Vessel tracking, port call history, fleet management	No predictive analytics, no customs intelligence	EUR 40-120/mo
Kpler	AIS tracking, terminal-level congestion, commodity flows	Enterprise-only, no SME tier, no Chilean customs data	Custom (>EUR 500/mo)
Vizion	Container tracking, dwell time benchmarks	Reactive (tracks what happened), no forecasting	Custom
Sinay	AI-based ETA, port congestion monitoring	Global focus, no Chile-specific customs data	Custom
Waze Cargo	Port congestion forecast 12 months ahead, commodity berth competition, swell and wind port closure risk	Our unique combination in one platform	EUR 0-350/mo

3. Value Proposition & Positioning

Core value proposition:

Waze Cargo predicts which Chilean ports will be congested months before your cargo arrives, combining 20 years of customs intelligence with real-time ocean weather forecasts, so you can pick the right port, avoid delays, and protect your margins.

Three key benefits:

First, avoid costly delays. Know weeks in advance if your target port will be congested and reroute before it is too late, protecting revenue, perishables, and contractual commitments. Second, make data-driven routing decisions. Replace gut feeling with ML-backed port recommendations that account for commodity competition, seasonal patterns, and weather disruption risk. Third, see what others cannot. While competitors tell you where your ship is, Waze Cargo tells you what will happen when it arrives, including whether ocean swells will shut the port down.

Positioning statement:

Waze Cargo is for Chilean importers and exporters who struggle with unpredictable port congestion and shipment delays, and its main benefit is transforming reactive logistics into proactive routing decisions using 20 years of customs data and real-time weather intelligence to predict port outcomes before they happen.

4. North Star Metric & KPIs

North Star Metric: Weekly Active Port Checks (WAPC)

Definition: The number of unique users who check at least one port congestion forecast or weather disruption alert per week. This metric captures the core value delivery. A user who checks port conditions regularly is getting value from the product, making better logistics decisions, and is likely to convert to a paying plan and retain over time. We chose this over signups because signups measure interest, not value. We chose it over revenue because revenue is a lagging indicator. By the time MRR drops, users have already left. WAPC drops first, giving us an early warning to fix retention before it becomes a revenue problem.

KPI 1 — Activation rate: The percentage of new signups who check at least two ports within their first seven days. Target: 40%. This measures whether the onboarding flow successfully delivers the aha moment, which is the user seeing a congestion prediction that is relevant to their actual trade routes.

KPI 2 — Free-to-Pro conversion rate: The percentage of free users who upgrade to the Pro plan within 60 days. Target: 8 to 12%. This measures whether the gap between the Free and Pro tiers is correctly calibrated. Below 8% means the Free tier gives too much value and there is no reason to upgrade. Above 12% means the Free tier is too restrictive and users churn instead of converting.

KPI 3 — Monthly churn rate: The percentage of Pro subscribers who cancel per month. Target: below 5%. This measures long-term value delivery. If users churn, the predictions are not actionable enough, the forecast accuracy has declined, or a competitor has caught up. Every one percent reduction in churn translates to approximately two more weekly active users retained in the base.

5. GTM Channels & Tactics — AARRR Funnel

Acquisition — How do people first hear about us?

What happens: Chilean importers and exporters discover Waze Cargo through three routes that fit a Barcelona-based student team with no sales budget. First, a public landing page that demonstrates the product before signup by showing live congestion forecasts for San Antonio and Valparaíso without requiring registration. Second, personalised cold outreach powered by 20 years of public Chilean customs data. Third, trust-transfer through international trading stakeholders reached via our Chilean teammate's professional network and LinkedIn. Visitors land on the homepage, see the product working with real predictions, and create a free account in under a minute.

Channel 1 — Public live dashboard on the homepage (no signup required): We show real-time congestion forecasts for San Antonio and Valparaíso directly on the homepage. Visitors see the product working before they register. This does three jobs at once. For SEO, people searching "congestión puerto San Antonio" land on a page that ranks because it contains unique data, not just marketing copy. For PR, maritime journalists at Mundo Marítimo and PortalPortuario can cite our forecasts in their articles, sending qualified traffic for free. For trust, SME owners in Chile are skeptical of SaaS products. Seeing live predictions before signing up removes the "is this real?" objection.

Channel 2 — Cold outreach using our customs database: We use 20 years of public Chilean customs data from SNA to send hyper-personalised emails. Each email references the recipient's actual shipping history, something no competitor can do. For example: "Hi María, your company shipped 14 containers through Valparaíso last March when the port ran 35% above capacity. Would you like the forecast for March 2027?" This approach is asynchronous, low-cost at around 50 euros per month for the outreach tool, and we position ourselves as students doing research rather than vendors selling, which generates higher reply rates.

Future expansion (months 4 to 6): Once we reach 50 or more active users and have case studies, we present our research findings at virtual events hosted by ASOEX, SOFOFA, and ProChile, positioned as academic research rather than sales. Each event reaches 100 to 300 decision makers.

Channels we skip: Google Ads because we cannot outbid Kpler and MarineTraffic. Physical events in Chile because they are too expensive for a Barcelona-based team. Facebook and Instagram ads because importers and exporters are not on those platforms for professional decisions.

KPIs:

KPI	Target	How we measure
Website visits	1,500 per month by month 3, 3,000 by month 6	Google Analytics
Click-through rate	Above 3% on cold outreach emails and LinkedIn DMs	Outreach tool and LinkedIn analytics
Visit to signup conversion	Above 10% of visitors create a free account	Product analytics
Cost per acquisition	Below 40 euros per free signup	Tool costs plus any ad spend divided by new signups

Activation — What is the “wowww” moment?

The wowww moment: The user checks congestion for a port they actually use and sees a prediction that matches their real-world experience, but with data they have never had before. They see a commodity breakdown showing which products compete for berth space, weather risk indicators for swells and wind, and an alternative port recommendation. This is the moment they realise that Waze Cargo gives them visibility no other tool provides.

How we get them there fast: The onboarding sequence is designed to reach the aha moment within minutes, not days. On signup, an onboarding email invites them to track their first shipment. An in-app walkthrough guides them through their first congestion forecast. Within one hour of signing up, a personalised welcome email arrives showing the congestion forecast for their selected port. An in-app tooltip or notification tells them: "Your port will be 40% above normal in March. Tap to see why."

Channels: In-app onboarding walkthrough on first login. Automated email sequence on Day 0, Day 3, and Day 7. For larger enterprises, a live demo webinar.

KPIs:

KPI	Target	What it measures
Activation rate	40%	Percentage of users who track their first shipment or check two or more ports in their first week
Time to value	Under 3 minutes	Time from signup to the user seeing their first delay prediction
Onboarding completion rate	70%	Percentage completing the full onboarding walkthrough
First-week engagement	3 or more sessions in week one	Login activity count in the first seven days

Retention — How do we keep them coming back?

Core question: Do importers and exporters come back and keep using Waze Cargo regularly?

Why retention is critical for Waze Cargo: Importers and exporters plan shipments weeks and months in advance and operate on tight seasonal cycles. Chilean fruit exports run from January to April, wine from January to March, and copper ships year-round. If Waze Cargo delivers accurate forecasts during one season, the natural retention driver is the next season. Users return because they trust the model's predictions from last time. The goal is to become the tool they open before every major routing decision, the same way a captain checks weather before departure.

Channel 1 — Monthly port congestion alerts: These are automated alerts sent when the ML model detects high congestion risk or adverse weather conditions at a user's frequently used ports. For example: "San Antonio forecast: WARNING level swell detected. Consider rerouting to Valparaíso." The ML model already produces a seven-day forecast per port. Sending alerts when the risk level reaches WARNING or CLOSED is a direct product feature that brings users back without them having to remember to check. This is the strongest retention channel for Waze Cargo.

Channel 2 — Monthly trade intelligence digest: A personalised report summarising commodity flow trends, port performance, and forecast accuracy for the user's specific HS codes and routes. Importers and exporters plan monthly. Fruit exporters check January to April windows, copper exporters plan quarterly shipments. A monthly summary of port performance and commodity flow trends gives them a reason to re-engage even between active shipments.

Channel 3 — In-app route history (future feature): Users will be able to track their past routing decisions versus actual congestion outcomes, creating a feedback loop that builds trust in the platform and also feeds data back into model training. This feature requires the frontend to be fully built and is flagged as a future development rather than a current retention channel.

KPIs:

KPI	Target	Rationale
Day 30 and Month 3 retention rate	60% at day 30, 40% at month 3	Day 30 checks if they use it for a real shipment. Month 3 checks if it becomes habitual across a full seasonal cycle.
Churn rate	Below 5% monthly	If a user queries one route and never comes back, the forecast was not useful or trustworthy. Directly measurable.
WAU and MAU	WAU during peak seasons (Jan to Apr), MAU year-round	Nobody checks port congestion daily. The meaningful metric is weekly active users during peak shipping seasons and monthly active users year-round.
Session frequency	At least once per shipment cycle	Realistic and specific to how importers and exporters actually work.
Forecast accuracy satisfaction	Post-shipment feedback survey	If the model predicted HIGH congestion and the user rerouted and saved time, they will come back. If the prediction was wrong, they will not. This is the core retention driver: trust in the model.

Revenue — How do we turn users into paying customers?

The strategy is "taste, then crave." The Free tier gives users enough value to build a weekly checking habit, but deliberately locks the features they need to make actual routing decisions. This creates natural upgrade demand without aggressive sales tactics.

What Free gives: Congestion labels for one port showing Low, Moderate, or High status. Monthly view only, with no weekly or daily granularity. No commodity detail, just the overall congestion number.

What Free deliberately locks behind Pro: Three things create the upgrade desire. First, the commodity table is visible but blurred. Users can see there is a table showing which products compete for berth space, but they cannot read the values. Second, swell and wind alerts are locked. A banner appears saying "Swell warning detected — upgrade to see details" at the exact moment the user needs the information most. Third, the routing recommendation is blocked. The system shows "We found a less congested port for your cargo" but requires Pro to reveal which port and why.

Channels:

In-app upgrade prompts are the primary channel, working through the blurred commodity table, locked swell alerts, and blocked routing recommendation. These are contextual, not spammy, and are triggered by specific user actions rather than timers.

The free trial to paid flow offers a seven-day Pro trial, but only to users who have checked ports at least twice. This ensures the trial reaches users who already understand the value and are most likely to convert.

Upsell emails reinforce the value gap with personalised messaging. For example: "You have checked San Antonio eight times this month. Pro users have visibility of all ports and save days per shipment. The sea does not wait. Now you can move before it does."

Promotions include three mechanics. A seasonal upgrade push gives Free users a one-time Pro preview during peak seasons such as grape harvest in March, cherry season in December, or copper exports in Q4, with the message: "See what is competing for your port THIS month." An annual plan discount offers twelve months for the price of ten, a 17% saving at 1,670 euros per year instead of 2,400. A trade association group deal gives ASOEX, CNC, and SOFOFA members 20% off Pro for the first year.

KPIs:

KPI	Target	Interpretation
Conversion rate free to paid	8 to 12%	Below 8% means Free is too generous. Above 12% means Free is too restrictive. The sweet spot means the value gap is correctly calibrated.
Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR)	2,000 euros by month 3, 5,000 by month 6	Measures whether we are growing predictably.
Annual Recurring Revenue (ARR)	40,000 euros by end of year one	The annual run rate that investors and partners evaluate.
Average Revenue Per User (ARPU)	200 euros per month	Below 150 means users pick the cheapest Pro tier. Above 250 means enterprise upsell is working.
Lifetime Value (LTV)	2,400 euros or more	ARPU multiplied by average months retained. At 200 euros per month for 12 months, one user is worth 2,400 euros over their lifetime.
LTV to CAC ratio	Above 3 to 1	If we spend 100 euros to acquire a user, they need to generate 300 euros or more in lifetime value. Below 3 to 1 is unsustainable.

Referral — How do happy customers bring new users?

What happens: Importers and exporters operate in tight professional communities. Freight forwarders manage multiple accounts, and trade associations connect hundreds of members. One satisfied user can unlock an entire network. In maritime logistics, the buyer community is senior and highly interconnected. Port directors, freight forwarders, and cargo operators regularly exchange recommendations at industry events. Platforms like Windward and Kpler grew significantly through this peer-recommendation dynamic within closed professional networks.

Referral channels:

"Invite a logistics partner" is the primary mechanic. Both the sender and the recipient receive one month of Pro for free. The invitation is shared via WhatsApp, which is the primary business communication channel in Chile. A logistics manager forwarding a link with the message "look at this, it warned me that San Antonio would be congested in March" carries more weight than any advertisement.

Testimonials and case studies tell real stories of users who avoided delays. For example: "How my shipments used to have constant delays because of port congestion, and now I can confidently choose a port to receive my cargo from Genoa to San Antonio."

Trade association exposure involves presenting at ASOEX for exporters, CNC which is the National Chamber of Commerce, and SOFOFA which is the industry federation. One presentation reaches multiple potential users within the target segment.

KPIs:

KPI	Target	Rationale
Percentage of users who refer	15%	Ambitious but realistic because one trusted voice in maritime logistics carries disproportionate weight. Measured by dividing the number of users who sent at least one successful referral by total active users in the same period.
Referral conversion rate	25%	General SaaS benchmarks place referred-user conversion at 20 to 40%, but maritime cargo intelligence has higher activation friction. We set 25% as a conservative floor. Measured by dividing referred signups who reached first meaningful action by total referred signups.
K-factor	Above 0.3	A K-factor of 0.3 means every 10 users organically bring 3 more. It will not produce viral growth, which requires K above 1, but it meaningfully reduces CAC. Calculated as average invites sent per user multiplied by conversion rate of those invites.
NPS	Above 50	Net Promoter Score measures promoters minus detractors. A score above 50 is considered excellent and is the leading indicator of whether the referral funnel can function at all. Calculated as percentage of promoters minus percentage of detractors.

7. Pricing & Business Model

Revenue model: Freemium SaaS with monthly subscription. The Free tier serves as the acquisition and habit-formation layer. The Pro tier is the core revenue driver. The Enterprise tier is the expansion target for large companies and channel partners.

Price tiers:

Tier	Price	What is included	Target user
Free	0 euros	Congestion labels (Low/Moderate/High) for one port, monthly view only, no commodity detail	User acquisition and habit formation
Pro	100 to 350 euros per month	Full congestion forecast for all ports, commodity breakdown, swell and wind alerts, alternative port recommendations, 12-month forecast, API access	SME importers and exporters with regular trade
Enterprise	Custom, starting at 500 euros per month	Multi-user dashboards, custom ERP and TMS integrations, dedicated support, fleet-level vessel tracking, white-label option for customs brokers	Large importers, freight forwarders, port authorities

Why this model fits the ICP: SMEs in Chile are price-sensitive and skeptical of SaaS products. The Free tier removes all risk from trying the product. The gap between Free and Pro is carefully designed so that Free creates a weekly checking habit while withholding the decision-support features that justify the Pro price. The Pro tier at 100 to 350 euros per month is positioned below MarineTraffic, which charges 100 to 150 euros for tracking only, and well below Kpler at over 500 euros, while delivering more actionable intelligence than either. Most importantly, a single avoided delay of three to five days at approximately 1,500 dollars per day in demurrage pays for two to four months of the Pro subscription. The ROI argument is immediate and concrete.

8. Launch Plan — First 90 Days

Goal linked to NSM: Reach 100 Weekly Active Port Checks with at least 10 paying Pro users generating 2,000 euros in MRR by the end of month three.

Month 1 — Foundation and Free Launch

Deploy the MVP web application using React and FastAPI on AWS EC2 with SSL and a custom domain. Launch the Free tier showing congestion forecasts for San Antonio and Valparaíso, covering both import and export directions. Publish four LinkedIn posts featuring port congestion insights to build authority and generate initial traffic. Reach out to three importers and exporters through the team's Chilean network and onboard them as beta partners with free access and a broker dashboard. Target: 50 free signups with 20 activated users who check two or more ports in their first week.

Month 2 — Activation and Pro Beta

Launch the weekly congestion digest email for all free users to drive retention. Enable swell and wind alerts for 10 selected active users as Pro beta testers. Run the first cold outreach campaign using customs data for hyper-personalised emails. Host the first live demo webinar in Spanish, targeting 30 attendees. Target: 100 total signups, 40 activated users, and 10 Pro beta users testing the full feature set.

Month 3 — Revenue and Referral

Launch the Pro tier publicly at 100 to 350 euros per month with a seven-day free trial for activated users. Activate the referral programme where both sender and receiver get one month of Pro free via WhatsApp invitation. Present at one trade association event, either ASOEX or a CNC chapter meeting. Publish the first case study featuring a beta Pro user who avoided a delay. Target: 150 total signups, 100 Weekly Active Port Checks, 10 paying Pro users, and 2,000 euros in MRR.

Top 3 experiments to run:

Experiment 1: Onboarding flow length. Hypothesis: a one-step onboarding that says "pick your port, see the forecast" will activate more users than a three-step onboarding that asks for role, ports, and preferences. Metric: activation rate at seven days. Channel: in-app, random 50/50 split of new signups.

Experiment 2: Free tier port limit. Hypothesis: limiting the Free tier to one port with full detail versus unlimited ports with limited detail creates stronger upgrade intent without hurting activation. Metric: Free to Pro conversion rate at day 30. Channel: in-app feature gating.

Experiment 3: Weather content versus congestion content for acquisition. Hypothesis: LinkedIn posts about weather-driven port closures, such as "San Antonio closed three times this winter due to swells," will generate more signups than posts about congestion data like "March congestion forecast for Chilean ports." Metric: click-through rate plus signup conversion from LinkedIn. Channel: LinkedIn organic, alternating post types weekly.

9. Risks & Assumptions

Biggest assumptions in this GTM:

We assume that Chilean SME importers and exporters will adopt a SaaS tool for logistics decisions. We assume the Free tier creates enough value to form a weekly habit but not enough to eliminate the need for Pro. We assume that the model's R-squared accuracy of 0.909 on historical data will translate to actionable accuracy on future predictions. We assume Open-Meteo weather data is reliable enough for port closure predictions along the Chilean coast.

Main risks and mitigation:

Risk	Severity	How we mitigate
Low SaaS adoption among Chilean SMEs	High	Free tier removes cost barrier. WhatsApp integration for alerts meets users where they already communicate.
Competitors add prediction features	Medium	Our moat is 20 years of Chilean customs data with commodity granularity. Global platforms will not build Chile-specific models for a niche within a 1.8 billion dollar global market.
ML accuracy degrades on future data	Medium	Walk-forward cross-validation designed to catch this. Monthly auto-retrain. Monitor prediction versus actual and alert if R-squared drops below 0.7.
Weather API reliability (Open-Meteo)	Low	Free API with no SLA. Fallback: SHOA buoy data as backup source. Consider paid marine weather API such as Stormglass for the Enterprise tier.
Customs data stops being publicly available	Low	SNA has published data since 2002 with no interruption. Risk is minimal but mitigation includes pursuing a data partnership with SNA or licensed data providers.
Team capacity — small team, large scope	High	Focus on two ports only for the MVP: San Antonio and Valparaíso. Expand to more ports only after product-market fit is confirmed with the first 50 paying users.